

I didn't know what I was going to do, but I was finished with markets in the city. I was never going back.

**Why? You had done very well in the markets.**

Because I had such a terrible experience with people—the company politics, people lying. In my view, all I had ever done for any of my employers was make money. And yet, I didn't have much money. Either I didn't get paid properly, or even when I had a contract, I got screwed on that. I found the whole experience to be very discouraging.

**How did you go from loving the markets, like it was a videogame you were being paid to play, to not even wanting to get a trading job?**

That's an interesting question, isn't it? In 1986, I had gone to the city to make some money until I figured out what I wanted to do. I never worked it out. I still haven't worked it out.

**Apparently, at some point, you did get back into the markets. How did that occur?**

It was a bit of coincidence. I was going on a fishing trip in Venezuela with an old buddy from NatWest. I traveled via New York, and while I was there, I spoke to an old broker contact who advised me to speak to First New York Securities.<sup>3</sup> I met with the two guys who had set up the business; both of them at the time were in their sixties. They wanted me to come work for First New York Securities for a fixed percentage of the profits I made. Initially, I was reluctant because of all the negative experiences I had, but eventually they convinced me to come to New York for a few months to give it a try.

After I had been there for a few months, the guy in charge said to me, "We have been talking about you. We decided you were a player."

I'm thinking, *Here it comes; I'm going to get screwed now.*

He continued, "We owe you a lot of money, but you have never mentioned it."

I said, "If I thought I needed a contract, I wouldn't be here. If you are telling me that I need one, I'll just go now, and you can just keep the money." Then in my poor attempt at humor I said, "And I am sure that if I fell under a bus, you would give money to my kids."